trees and other obstructions from the roads, and a journey of eight hours took them two to three days. The administrative set-up and the law and order machinery was in a traumatized mess. Not surprisingly, everyone had gotten busy trying to reorganize their own personal lives. The sad reality was that their official duties and functions had taken a back seat.

My stay in the Army HQ as the ADGMO was one of the longest ever in that post. It happened because the government announced a two-year extension of service across the board for all. In fact, our promotion board from major general to lieutenant general had to be held two times.

It was during this tenure that my son, Vivek, got married to his French girlfriend, Anna. We went to attend their wedding in Normandy during the summer of 1998. It was a simple but elegantly arranged function, with a registered marriage followed by a reception and a lovely dinner which carried on till the wee hours. In the merrymaking we danced and most of us had more than our share of champagne, cheese and wine. Later in the year they came to Delhi for celebrating the wedding in true Punjabi traditions in the gurdwara. They have two wonderful daughters, Anne-Tara and Marie-Sana, and live in a country home near St Lo, in Normandy. Vivek runs a business in designing and developing handicrafts, household accessories and gift items and sources them from India, while Anna works for a social organization. My daughter, Urvashi Kaur (Sonia as we call her), is an acclaimed fashion designer, and her husband, Gagan Dugal, runs a successful global company that provides services for cellular communications. They have three wonderful children – Seerat, Suveer and Sumair – and live in Delhi.

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[1] *The Times of India*, 24 June 1999, 'Tell the World the Truth, Jamaat Tells Pakistan PM'.

[2] *How I Started a War, Time* magazine, 12 July 1999.

[3] *Kargil Review Committee Report*, p. 95.

[4] Bill Clinton, *My Life*, Knopf, 2004, p. 865.